

*LIVING THE VISION OF
THE VISIONARY*
The Editorial

#CIRS Impact 2.0
The Editorial Team

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Oppenheimer - A
Man Beyond
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Sairam Gopal

*From Cavemen to Cybernauts: the Top
Three Inventions that Made Us Smart,
Smarter and the Smartest!*
Aryan Khedkar (Alumnus)



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#CrossCaptures

#CrossCaptures - A normal CIRS Sunday with a healthy dose of The Crossroads
Ft. Vanshika Khemani (Grade 12)
Captured by Rishi Suresh Iyer (Grade 11)



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From Cavemen to Cybernauts

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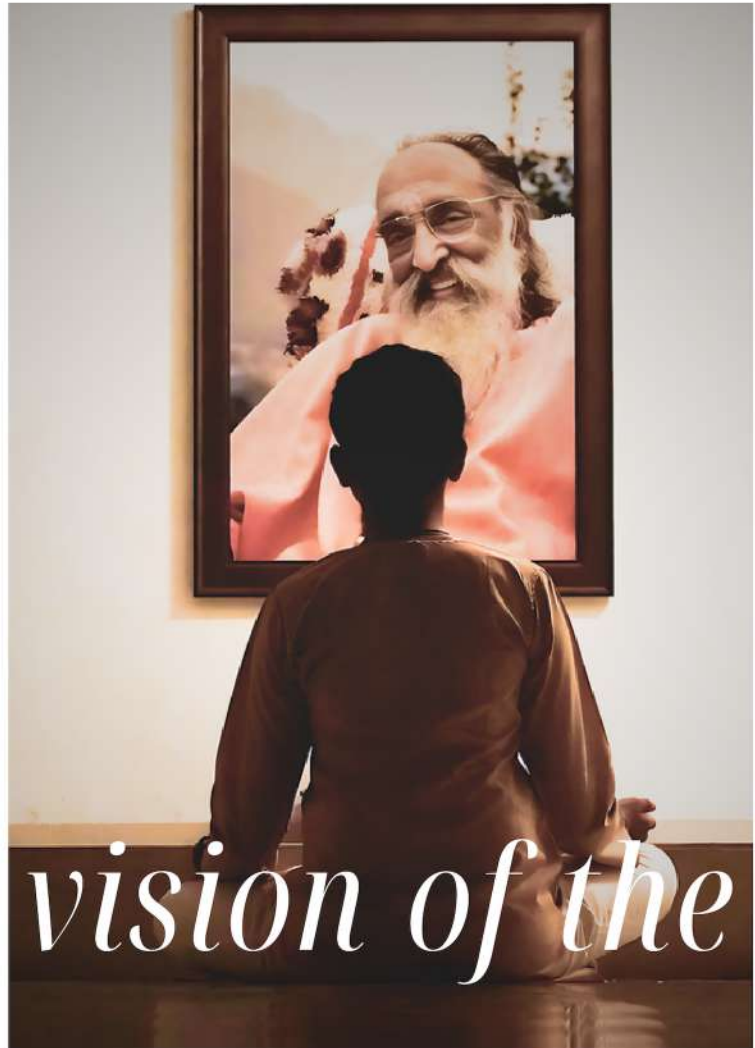
THE EDITORIAL

Tavishi Bagaria | Grade 11 MGMT, CIRS

“Vision - Action = Imagination;
Action - Vision = Division;
Vision + Action = Transformation. A
narrow vision is divisive.
A broad vision is expansive.
The Supreme vision is
all-inclusive”

Guruji Swami Tejomayananda ji

Living the vision of the visionary



When endowed with the right vision, each human being becomes a powerhouse of virtue. A transformative force, they inspire positive change in the world around them while growing themselves. Day-to-day life almost always clouds and veils this vision, resulting in our lives being monotonous as we try to keep up with the changing times.

However, to combat this, Pujya Gurudev Swami Chinmayananda left all of us with a vision. An unchanging, undying, unshakable ideal which guides us through the dynamics of modern society. “Give maximum happiness to the maximum people for the maximum amount of time.”

A seed of virtue was sown by Gurudev. This seed has today grown and become a part of our life,

protecting us from all disparities and giving us all that we need. Gurudev had a vision, a vision to make each and every one of us proud of our unique cultural identity, our beliefs and our values. He wished for these values and virtues to flow through us to the world around us. Living and upholding this vision, we strive forward, becoming better than what we were before.

The impact a vision has on our life is huge. To understand this, here's a story: There lived a wealthy man with a content lifestyle. One day he was bothered with severe pain in his eyes. He consulted many physicians, but none could treat his ache. He went through a myriad of treatment procedures, but his pain persisted.

He looked for every available solution for his pain, and then he came across a wise monk, renowned for treating various illnesses. The monk carefully observed the man's eyes and offered a very peculiar solution.

The monk told the man to concentrate only on green colour for a few weeks and avoid any other colour. The man was desperate to get rid of the pain and was determined to go to any extent. The wealthy man appointed a group of painters, purchased barrels of green paint and directed that every object that his vision was likely to fall on be painted green.

A few weeks later, when the wise monk came for a regular visit to the wealthy man, he was surprised to see the corridors and objects in his house painted green. On his way to the wealthy man's room, a hired painter poured green paint on the monk. As the monk inquired about the reason behind painting everything green, the wealthy man said that he was only following the monk's advice to see only green. Hearing this, the monk laughed and said, "If only you had purchased a pair of green spectacles, worth just a few dollars, you could have saved a large share of your fortune. You cannot paint the world green."

From this story we understand that if we change the way we look at things, the things we look at change by itself. To have a vision given by our Guru himself can definitely ignite a change in the way we see and perceive things.

Thus, we are presented with the theme 'Living the Vision of the Visionary', for the academic year 2024-25, on the occasion of the 108th Jayanti of our Gurudev. Life, when empowered by a vision, transcends the limits of human endeavours.

Living the vision of the visionary enables all of us to rise to the highest we possibly can. "Keep your goal so high, you never reach it. But in the process of striving for the goal, you shall grow", said Pujya Gurudev. The same too, is for a vision. As we constantly strive to live Pujya Gurudev's vision, we exceed our potential.

A vision transforms an individual right from the very source of his action - his thoughts. Once the thoughts of the individual align with a lofty vision, their perspective shifts, changing their mindset in life. Having altered the mindset, the individual inevitably transforms their actions which changes their life. All of this, spawning from one thing - vision!



Curated Quips



01. Gp. Captain Prasanth Nair, Chinmaya Vidyalaya Pallavur Alumnus, selected for ISRO's Gaganyaan Mission

Gp. Captain Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair, one of the four astronauts selected for ISRO's Gaganyaan Mission is a proud alumnus of CV Pallavur. He constantly stayed connected with the institution to inspire the youth with his journey and achievements. We are very proud of Prasanth Ji's achievements and hope that this inspires students from our school too, to reach such heights!



02. India's longest cable-stayed bridge inaugurated by PM Modi

Prime Minister Modi inaugurated India's longest four-lane cable-stayed bridge, The Sudarshan Setu, on 25th February. It took 6 years to complete. The bridge is 2.32km long and cost around 980 crore. It features a footpath adorned with verses of Bhagavad Gita which promotes reflection, contemplation, and connection to Bharatiya heritage.

03. World's 2nd largest Hindu temple inaugurated in Abu Dhabi

The BAPS Hindu Mandir was ceremonially consecrated in Abu Dhabi on the 14th of February by His Holiness Mahant Swami Maharaj. The temple is an architectural marvel with intricate carvings that include representations of horses, camels, falcons, etc. It includes figurines of Hindu deities like Sri Ram and Sri Ganesh. The temple complex serves the wider region as a hub for cultural and spiritual activities.



04. NASA to send coded message in Hindi to Jupiter's moon Europa to possibly hidden 'alien life'

The American space agency NASA is preparing for the upcoming Europa Clipper Mission to Jupiter's moon, set to launch in October. This mission holds particular significance as Europa exhibits compelling evidence of harboring an ocean beneath its icy surface, reportedly containing over double the volume of water found in all of Earth's oceans combined. Notably, scientists have meticulously recorded a message in 103 languages, including Hindi, which will be conveyed through the spacecraft on this groundbreaking expedition.



TWEETS & TRUST: POLITICS IN THE AGE OF REELS

"The spread of misinformation can erode trust in the democratic process and distort the public's understanding of key issues. There are memes featuring political pioneers which are out in the public. How it affects one's social circle and position in the world of politics is difficult to comprehend".

In an era dominated by the continuous buzz of social media, one must give a thought to how our relentless scrolling through random feeds and personalized content has led not only to the influencing of our thought processes, but also to a profound polarization of societies. Media's impact is maximum on the very base of democracy: the people. Aren't people the purpose of elections being held? Do they not contribute to the indispensable embroidery of the political fabric? Firstly, what is social media? It acts as an amplifier for the happenings in and around the world. People judge other people based on how they portray themselves on a social forum. Many a time, politicians deceive the public by repetitively playing one-time incidents to attract public attention and sympathy.

Perspective is a crucial entity when it comes to decision-making and debate. It sculpts the thought process of the thinker and the understanding of the listener. The competent judge never abstains from listening to all the available standpoints. Now, there are two ways to look at the bearings of social media: beneficial and detrimental. The most utilized feature of any social platform is its ability to spread the voice of an individual in the haste of time.

Living in a democracy, one should be aware that it is important to hear not just from the members of the parliament, but also from the general public. As Abraham Lincoln had said, "Democracy is the government of the people, by the people and for the people." Furthermore, people sometimes have feasible solutions to world crises. To put it in simpler words, sometimes hearing out to the public can show the light at the end of the tunnel.

It is also possible that people use this vital feature to circulate content like fake news, targeted ads and luring statements intending to manipulate public opinion. Actions like these tend to scar the face of the victim online and offline. It tarnishes the hard-earned reputation built through years of making sound decisions and executing effective strategies. The spread of misinformation can erode trust in the democratic process and distort the public's understanding of key issues. There are memes featuring political pioneers which are out in the public.

Simultaneously, social media can help in establishing a transparent government too. It is funny how we call social media 'social' media, as it does the exact opposite of what physical media does. For better understanding, let's assume that there is a politician who made a statement on a critical issue. The physical media can record the part they want to tamper with and criticize the politician on their channels. However, in social media, official statements from politicians are directly conveyed to the public through verified accounts. By bypassing traditional channels, this approach allows politicians to communicate directly with the audience, fostering a more immediate and unfiltered connection between leaders and the public. In a nutshell, it serves as a transparent mode of communication.



How it affects one's social circle and position in the world of politics is difficult to comprehend. Memes tangle humor with substantial political content, creating a fusion that can simultaneously engage and minimize discourse on politics, blurring the lines between serious debate and light-hearted banter. Summing up, determining whether social media exerts a positive or negative influence on politics and elections proves to be challenging. The issue is not a straightforward dichotomy of black or white, rather it's a tangled and complex grey landscape.

As highlighted in the aforementioned points, it is evident that social media unquestionably exerts a deep and impactful influence. The subtle aspects of its impact, marked by both constructive and detrimental features, highlight the necessity for a thorough investigation into its role in shaping political scenarios and electoral processes. In essence, while definitive categorization eludes us, the impact of social media on politics is a substantive and undeniable reality.

02 Communication

Shreiyaan P. Shah | Grade 8, CIRS



Communication in today's world is highly essential, both in business life and in private life. Effective communication helps us understand people and situations better. Did you know that good and effective communication helps us overcome diversities, build trust and respect, and create conditions for sharing creative ideas and solving problems? Communication also plays a vital role in shaping and defining one's life.

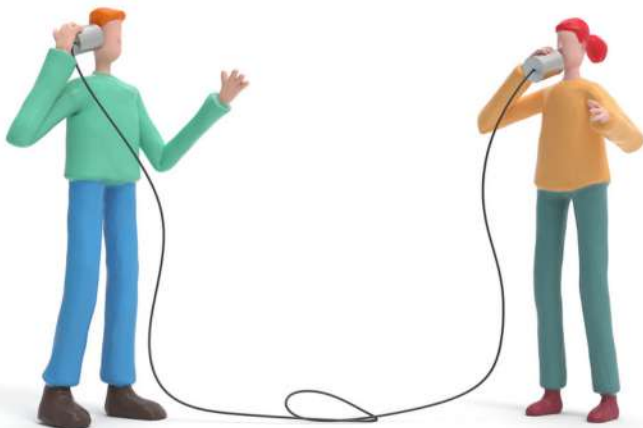
Let me share my personal opinion and experience on this topic. About 9 years ago, my self-esteem was quite low and I had the fear of being misjudged all the time. I lacked the confidence to talk to even my relatives during usual hangouts. I was far behind the rest in having proper body language and I wasn't the kind of guy who would start a conversation myself. I used to be constantly anxious during class hours as well, just because I didn't know how to communicate well.



My parents were quite worried about me regarding this matter, because social interaction is essential for one's life.

Then I was forced to sign up for classes in communication skills for the betterment of my speech. The first few weeks were regrettable, because they made me speak tremendously more than I expected. I felt like I was embarrassing myself. But then, as time passed on, I slowly started getting the hang of it.

Those teachers also trained us for appearing in the Trinity College London Communication Skills exams. TCL assesses how candidates use language as a tool for communicating in particular contexts, rather than assessing the fluency of the language itself.



It wasn't easy, of course. I had to bust my head all night just to speak a line fluently without stuttering. After months of speaking, my confidence level grew higher and higher.

I appeared for more and more TCL levels over the years and I can definitely say it has improved my understanding of communication, way better than before.

Good communication skills are essential to allow others and yourself to understand information more accurately and quickly. In contrast, poor communication skills lead to frequent misunderstandings and frustration.

One very important aspect in communication skills is having good body language. Can you imagine a speaker with a stiff body, excessive usage of hand gestures and a lack of maintenance of eye contact with the listener? No, right?

So, what I'm trying to get across is that while speaking, we should have a relaxed body stance to increase confidence, maintain eye contact so that the listener feels involved, and have a friendly tone to make the listener feel comfortable.

Now, I say that my communication skills have improved phenomenally more than I had expected. Just last October I graduated from Trinity College London and last December I hosted a stage show and a quiz. This was only possible because of the small tips given to me on apt communication.

Whenever you're speaking, always remember that there's no rush and you don't have to catch a train. Maintain your pace, talk clearly and emphasize on key words which will help the listener understand better. Be sure and correct your tone of speaking, your loudness or your pitch while talking.

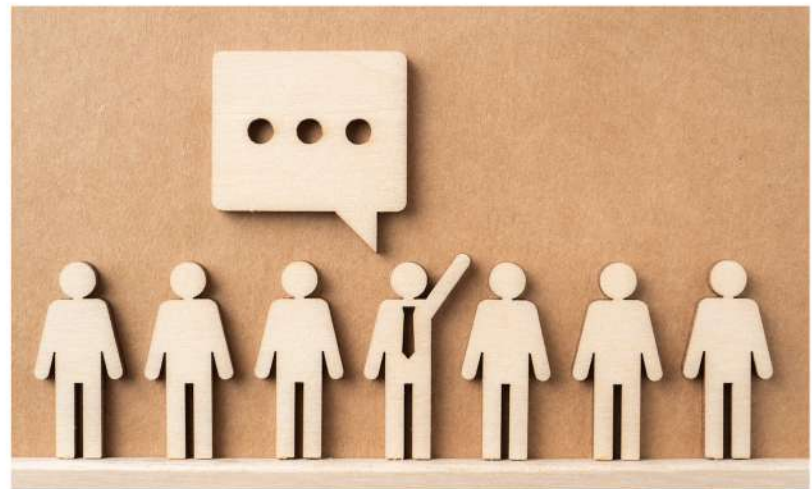
You will also come across many situations where you don't agree with someone. For example, you might have argued with a friend of yours, right? So, in such scenarios, try understanding their point of view rather than just putting your point across. Respect their opinion and do not make them feel low even if you don't agree with them. This will create a big impact on your friend circle.

Good communication skills can aid in helping you land an interview and pass the selection process, and if you can speak well, it will give you a great advantage. To do your job effectively, you have to discuss problems, request information, interact with others, and have good human relations skills – these are all part of having good communication skills. They help in being understood well and in understanding the needs of those around you.

To conclude, I would like to state that communication works only for those who work on it and I would also like to share a famous quote by Robert Frost.

“Half the world is composed of people who have something to say and can't, and the other half who have nothing to say and keep on saying it.”

In a world of overflowing noise and unending quarrels, the ability to communicate well is a superpower. As Robert Frost so aptly observed, “Half the world is composed of people who have something to say and can't, and the other half who have nothing to say and keep on saying it.” As we work and grow through our education, let us become a part of the first half, but with excellent communication. Let us become communicators who have great ideas, build bridges and unlock our full potential. Take a deep breath, find your voice and become a roaring lion who rules the world through his words.



The Texas Sharpshooter Fallacy

Trailblazing with TOK



Let me introduce you to my imaginary friend from Texas. He doesn't know head or tail about shooting, but still considers himself a sharpshooting wizard. Here's how he does it. He fires off a random shot. It might hit something, anything - a wall, a roof or a tree. But here's the beauty. Wherever his shot lands, he picks up his handy paintbrush, walks right over, and paints a target around it! So he gets a perfect bullseye. Every. Single. Time.

But the story of the Texas sharpshooter isn't one that lies solely in the realm of fiction. In fact, we use his tactics on a day-to-day basis. Not with bullets, but with words. We fix certain ideas and cherry-pick evidence to support them, while turning a blind eye to any contradicting evidence. A simple elucidation - Rahul (your average middle-schooler) says that he's an amazing football player because he won a match against the district team. He conveniently ignores the fact that he was subbed out after the first half and has lost five consecutive games since. So, my fellow logic warriors, steer clear of this wily trap, or you might find yourself following the ways of the Texas sharpshooter - shooting words at nothing and painting evidence around them.

03

Camp Youreka: Where Boredom Goes to Die

E. Viswanath Chaitanya
and Preetham Rampeesa
| Grade 9, CIRS

YOUREKA CAMP



Exhausted from exams and eager for a fresh start, our 9th-grade class embarked on an educational tour unlike any other – a thrilling adventure, an adventure to rejuvenate us for the oncoming trials, at the Youreka camp nestled amidst the verdant coffee plantations and picturesque hills of Yercaud.

As the first rays of dawn painted the sky on February 27th, anticipation crackled in the air. The bus ride was a pretty long one; the climb to the campsite, a winding path up the hill, served as a welcome burst of energy, washing away travel fatigue.



We were warmly welcomed by the instructors and staff; we were addressed and then we settled into our tents. After that we were divided into our adventure groups and immediately had our first activity. Everything was so fast over there. There were no brakes to our zeal and things only kept getting better. The first activity was the trust walk. We had to select and blindfold a partner and we would guide our partner down a route with no physical contact. Then we settled down for the long day.

The next morning, we all woke up to the serene sunrise peeking through the hills, and while some of us flocked to get pictures, others eagerly awaited a steaming cup of hot chocolate to kickstart the day.

Our initial thoughts of a routine morning jog were quickly dispelled with the introduction of 'Chhota Hazri.' But this wasn't your ordinary jog; it transformed into a joyous dance session, filling us with energy for the day's adventures.

Over the three days we had six exhilarating activities which were carried out in the morning and evening sessions each day. Rappelling down a cliff face offered a unique thrill, and the challenge of ascending back through the bushes added another layer of excitement.





The next activity was river crossing; this is where the adventure kicked in. Well, some of us had a fear of heights and this scared them to death. We had to descend from a higher point on the hill to the other side across the gorge and for those who wanted a challenge, the option to climb back up the hill was readily available.

Tree jumaring, using a special jumar equipment to ascend a rope, provided a different kind of challenge. The most informative session, however, was the Outdoor Survival (ODS) program.

We learned invaluable skills like building shelters, making fires, and even whipping up a surprisingly delicious meal in the wilderness – all with minimal resources!



The friendship ladder wasn't just an activity, it was a symbol of our camaraderie. The only objective was to scale the humongous ladder, working together and ensuring that your partner wasn't left behind. This was the talk of the town in our grade. There were records being made of who got to the top first and as the days passed, they were being broken.

The final activity where everyone participated together was 'Helter Skelter'. It was a series of short games which would test our physical and mental abilities; it was a perfect ending to our chain of adventures.

Moreover, every evening we had our 'cool time' where we would introspect ourselves on the day that had passed and reflect upon it by writing down how we felt.

Later in the evening after soup we had 'camp fun', where we played short games which were introduced to us by the instructors. This was the time where all of us came together.

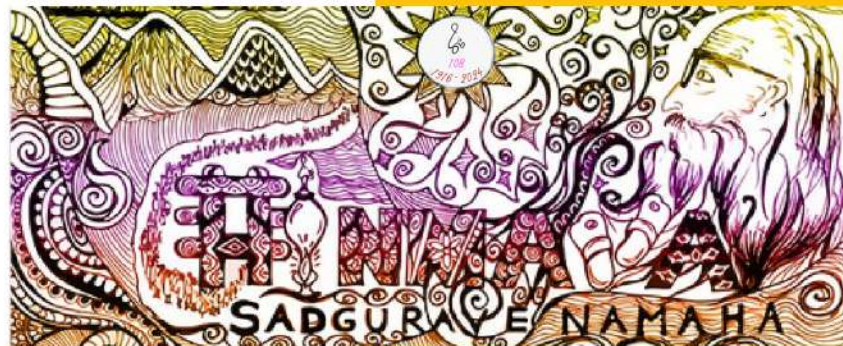


Youreka was a transformative experience. Fears were overcome, new bonds were made and older ones strengthened, some of us discovered a whole new world of possibilities and finally we got the break we were longing for. All of us enjoyed our hearts out.



In Gurudev's Light

Poems & Reflections



My Guru's Glory

A Guru is much more than a mere teacher; he teaches us how to live life. He does not judge us for our flaws or give up on us, but rather, teaches us to be better. He knows us, understands us and is there for us. He loves us and wants what is best for us. We live to please that Guru; our only goal is to follow his ideals and live. He is none other than Swami Chinmayananda - my Guru, our Guru.

Vishv Prem Nangia | Grade 8, CIRS

The Radiance of My Guru

O Guru! The one who is at par with the gods,
All knowledge you impart of those wonderful lords!
Your precious blessing, worth all the wealth of the world,
We carry, by you all mysteries are slowly unfurled.

Rhea Sontakke | Grade 8, CIRS

Guru - the Supreme

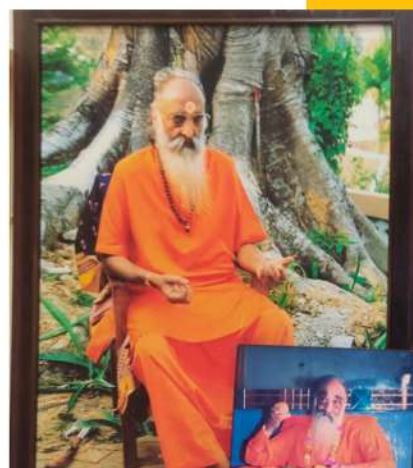
O Guru! With knowledge you bless me.
O Guru! You broaden my vision, with clarity you help me see.
You are the manifestation of the lord.
O Guru! After all, you are like my God.

Hitansh Jain | Grade 8, CIRS

Dear Guru, you get a 10/8

We students are like wet clay,
But O Guru! You are the one who forms us under the sun's ray.
You are great, you are the one who decides our fate.
If I were to rate, I would give you a ten out of eight.

Aaditya Tulsyan | Grade 8, CIRS



STOCK MARKET DECODED

A BEGINNER'S PLAYBOOK

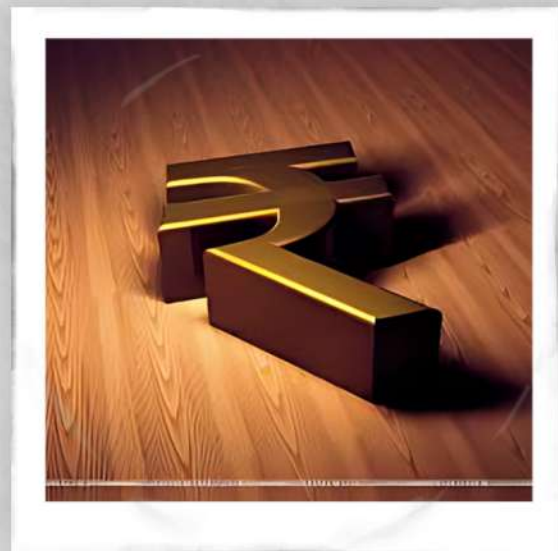


As a teenager fascinated by finance, I found the stock market to be very confusing and complex. Every blog post and video I came across made it seem intricate and very difficult to comprehend. But after a little digging into the dynamics of this beautiful world of numbers, I have come to understand that it is actually very simple and fascinating.

To understand the stock market, let's take the analogy of an auction house. Instead of dealing with fragile showpieces or very rare watches, the stock market deals with the shares of different companies. It is where we, the public, can indulge in the buying and selling of a company's equity. The value of these shares is determined by various factors such as company performance, economic indicators, and market trends. With a basic understanding of stock market dynamics, anyone can invest wisely and make informed decisions.

Understanding the Stock Market

To understand the entire concept, we must first understand what stock means. In simple words, stock refers to a share of ownership in a company. When you buy stock, you buy a small piece of the company, making you a partial owner. Therefore, the stock market, in essence, is a platform for the public to invest their idle money, and for companies to sell their equity to raise capital. The main objective of every investment made is obviously to generate profit. The radical strategy persisting in the stock market is 'buy low, sell high.' To predict the price movement of a stock, traders often analyze the financial history, current position and plans of the company.

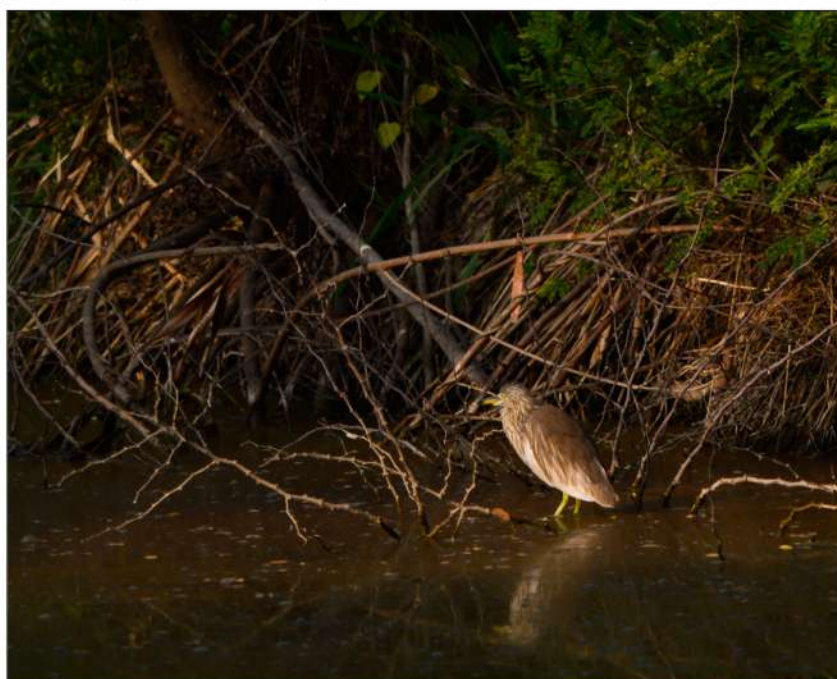


To successfully invest and generate profit, one must understand what one is getting into and the risks that may prevail. Diversification, which is not being anchored to just one industry and exploring all the available options, can help mitigate risks. Additionally, one must be well-versed and up-to-date with global events, economic indicators and market trends. It is important to understand that it is not guaranteed that one will make a profit. Losses may come and go along the journey, but strategic analysis helps avoid losses. A person pursuing the world of stocks must be patient, willing to learn continuously and develop their financial literacy. To sum up, the stock market is an established platform where investors and companies trade with each other to gain profit. With knowledge and a strategic approach, a person can embrace wealth whilst still acknowledging the prevailing risks. Remember, the stock market journey is a lifelong learning process, and pays well to all who approach it with the right mindset.

The Art of Bird Watching

Pradyuth S, Arya & Ishaan Madhusudhanan | Grade 7, CIRS

If you find yourself lying jobless on your bed (which happens very often), we would highly recommend you to take up the hobby of bird watching. It is a pleasant experience, the perfect activity to do when you're feeling down or sad. It will give you immense pleasure, especially when you discover a new bird, even if it's just another type of crow. The amount of happiness and pride you feel when you find a new bird is tremendous. Like the time we found a tiny black duck swimming in a pond tried to find out what it was, but we just weren't able to. Then, two more birding sessions later, we saw it again and were able to find out what it was; it was the 'Little Grebe'! It's truly a huge understatement to say that we were just happy, it was probably the best experience that we had out of all the bird watching trips we have gone to.



Bird watching also teaches you to be grateful to nature and truly shows you how beautiful the world is. What is initially nothing but melodious background noise proceeds to become a new opportunity to find a bird that you've never seen before. This habit of noticing every little sound made by the birds helps improve your concentration and spatial awareness. It is thus because when you try to look for the bird making the noise, you have to focus a lot to locate where the noise is coming from. But due to a rapid increase in pollution, caused by our factories and the destruction of habitats, many species of birds are going extinct, such as the 'Himalayan Quail.' By going for bird watching excursions, you are indirectly supporting the cause of protecting birds.

In fact, our school is an amazing place to go bird watching! Unlike the rest of the schools that merely offer sports, we have a tradition of starting every Sunday morning with bird watching. It is always a serene experience, when your surroundings are filled with the chirping of the birds and the cool breeze blows on the peaceful surroundings. The dance of the peacock or the mystifying look of the purple sunbird are just the things you need to make you smile when you're bored or in a bad mood.

By far the best place in the entire school to go bird watching (and our go-to spot) is the lake. There is a crazy amount of birds that we can find there, be it the tiny and fat Indian pond heron or the white-throated kingfisher. There are even nests of birds scattered around our school, like the ones of the yellow-billed babblers right outside the IB block! You can even find peregrine falcons (the fastest birds on the planet) in our school!

Items needed to go bird watching:

- A pair of binoculars
- A camera
- A book of birds
- A rough note (to store feathers you have found and to note down the birds you have found)
- Silence

A few good places to go bird watching in India:

- Kaundinya Bird Sanctuary in Andhra Pradesh
- Bharatpur Bird Sanctuary in Rajasthan
- Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary in Uttar Pradesh
- Nal Sarovar Bird Sanctuary in Gujarat





Bird watching is an underrated practice that deserves more attention than it gets. At the heart of bird watching lies the discovery of one's true self hidden in the canopy of Mother Nature's beauty.



07 #CIRS Impact 2.0

- the Editorial Team



Q5) Haardhik and Aditya, throughout your 8 years at CIRS, who has been your biggest inspiration and why?

Aditya: In every different area, different people have inspired me to excel in that particular field. Like Vaibhav (an alumnus) inspired me to perform in quizzes.

Haardhik: D.J. Ciranthan (another alumnus) was a very good friend of mine. He is a very responsible person and an amazing academic performer. He was one of the few people who genuinely enjoyed academics. I aspire to be like him. He was a really amazing guy, whom I'm still in touch with.

Ankitha: It's always been... half-and-half. You take inspiration for this from this person, inspiration for that from that person... there hasn't been one extremely inspiring personality as such. You take different things from different places. CIRS as a whole, really.

Haardhik: Yeah. Put that down - CIRS as a whole.

Everybody: CIRS as a whole!

Q6) There were people in your batch who left and pursued JEE and NEET coaching outside CIRS. How would you contrast their experience with yours?



Unanimously: Most of them regretted it. The pressure outside is way more than what we feel inside CIRS. They work like machines. We can't even imagine living life like that. CIRS just makes you used to so many things happening. Outside there's nothing. Life's just studies and nothing more.

Q7) What is one thing you found here that you will not find anywhere else?



Haardhik: Support. Everyone around you in CIRS supports you so much. Teachers, especially. When compared to outside, CIRS students have so much more connection with their teachers.

Ankitha: Genuine people. Not the toxic kind of people everywhere. The toxicity in this ecosystem is almost negligible. Comparatively, it is a lot less than what people experience outside. All your friends always push you to be better. I don't think it's that constructive anywhere else. The student community in CIRS is very close-knit.

Aditya: I totally agree. I've spent almost all of my childhood here and I feel closer to my CIRS friends than my cousins.

Q8) What is one thing that you would want to see in everybody in CIRS?

Haardhik: Conviction. Believe in something, but stick to it. It's very easy to go ahead with the flow, especially when it comes to vices like gambling. That "I know what is good for me, and that is what I will follow" mentality is necessary.

Thriambakesh: I have only one philosophy in life - you smile and make everyone around you smile.

Everyone: (applause) Wow, wow!

Ankitha: This is a movie dialogue, I'm 100% sure!

Thriambakesh: See, since the middle of 10th grade, I began to think what I would do when these people were gone. Then I decided that I wouldn't fight, shout or yell at any of them, and that's when this 'keep smiling' motto came to be.



08 *Is It Just Me?*

Niyati Bhukania | Grade 8, CIRS



Is there an end to my misery?
Or is it just me, running behind a never-ending
treasure?
Is there something more to achieve than mere fame?
Or will I just be another unknown name?
My life was once vibrant, but now it feels gray and
pale,
Why is my life weighing me down at such an
unimaginable scale?
Masks upon masks with no one knowing their identity,
I sometimes wonder how it would feel to live a life of
serenity.
Is there a way to escape this never-ending maze?
Or is it just me, pulling myself back into a haze?
Will I ever find a person who will understand me like
no other?
Or will my thoughts break me someday, piece by
piece or all together?

Everyone is ready to judge me, as flammable as
matches,
But how can I tell them that my once beautiful
world
Is already down to ashes?
Is my life a mist with liquid silence,
And the people who I expect to pull me out of it
Are actually the ones pushing me in?
Behind that happy smile resides a girl who is
broken and depressed,
But how can I word this?
When this feeling is something that can't be
expressed,
It is probable my life will always be a burden,
But I will always have myself, and of that I'm
certain!

09

From Cavemen to Cybernauts: the Top Three Inventions that Made Us Smart, Smarter and the Smartest!

Aryan Khedkar | Alumnus | Imperial College, London

3.4 MILLION inventions were filed for patents in just 2022, WIPO says. However, there seem to be only three extraordinary inventions that define our lives today! Picture this: It's 7 AM and you wake up to say "Hey Google, good morning!" Without even rolling out of your bed, your voice assistant greets you, tells you the latest news, gives you the weather forecast and even plays your favorite morning jam. Futuristic inventions are here for us. But are they the greatest?

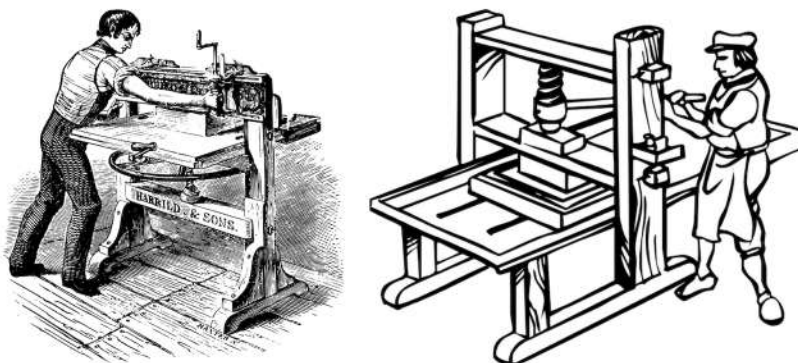
When we are able to talk to our friends at the other corner of the world, WhatsApp gets the praise. When we are able to learn about anything with a simple search, Google gets the love. When we are able to get something delivered the same day to our doorsteps, Amazon gets lauded. But what lies behind all these great innovations?

The stories of the top three inventions go back. Way back in our history textbooks... Imagine yourself traveling back in time to Mesopotamia. It's 3500 BC and you are walking through a bustling market, filled with traders and merchants haggling over goods. Suddenly, you hear a loud rumble in the distance, growing louder and louder until it's deafening. You turn around and you see a massive cart rolling towards you, pulled by two strong bulls.



The cart is loaded with goods, and it's moving with ease, unlike anything you've ever seen before. How? The Wheel. A game-changer for transportation, because of which we could now move things over longer distances without breaking our backs (or the bull's).

You might say, "There's no way that a piece of wood is the greatest invention!", but you couldn't be further from the truth. The Wheel made possible the invention of something even better, the waterwheel. The waterwheel made the creation of mechanical power possible. Then, we could make machines that did our heavy yet menial work for the first time. That's the beginning of innovation - the beginning of automation!



What are inventions for if not for making our lives simpler by delegating the work we had to do to a machine? Soon after the waterwheel followed the invention of clocks, steam-engines, and turbines. All inventions were possible because we humans invented a way of "innovating" through the Wheel, making it the Original Greatest Invention! Fast forward to the 15th century, and we see the arrival of the Printing Press by Johannes Gutenberg.

Picture this: You are a skilled worker in Greece in 1410 and want to learn about Aristotle because your friends from work told you that he was a wise man who lived in your town. How much do you think you would have to pay for a book that taught you about Aristotle? A day's wage? A week's wage? A month's wage? Nope, nope, and nope. You would have to pay your wage of about three-to-four-months to get your hands on a SINGLE book! The snail-paced book production (if copying by hand is even considered 'production') was replaced by mass production of written materials because of the Printing Press.

With this new way of knowledge distribution, it wasn't just deep-pocketed aristocrats who were privileged to be knowledgeable anymore, but even the common populus like you and I! Knowledge was cheaper and more accessible which revolutionized human societies, leading to intellectual revolutions.

It is great because the press fundamentally improved how humans innovated. Gone were the days when only the rich could invent because access to knowledge made the inventions of everything that followed easier for everyone!

As more and more machines were invented, the next five centuries seemed to be all about better and faster machines but nothing out of this world. Until 1989... Enter Sir Tim Berners-Lee of CERN. This man pioneered the modern-day internet by inventing the World Wide Web (WWW). The impact of the Internet is so profound that if a man from the 80s steps into modern day society, he'd be shocked to his bones seeing that the average Joe can see, hear and talk to someone who is sitting at the other end of the world! A global network of communication and information exchange that facilitated unimaginable levels of access to information and knowledge.



How were our lives changed? Our work, our education, our entertainment and our social interactions, all of it transformed as the Internet facilitated the development of smarter machines - the Technologies. The Smartphone, Social Media, and Cloud Computing brought more ease into our lives than anything we have ever seen - all possible because of the Internet. Our communities are no longer tied to our surroundings but have exploded to every corner of the world. The globalization of the world economy and the spread of democracy and human rights has enabled people around the world to connect and collaborate in ways that were previously just dreamlike.



That's what the greatest inventions we have ever created do - they make our present look like a futuristic science fiction movie scene! These are the revolutionary innovations that serve as a testament to human genius. It's difficult to rank them in the order of importance because they all changed the world in their uniquely different ways. But if there was one thing we learned from this dive into the past, it would be this: Inventions make us understand the immense human potential that lies within all of us. With this awareness, we can gather the strength to look at the future with hope. These inventions have not only simplified our lives but have revolutionized the way we communicate, learn, and think. As we continue to advance in technology and innovation, it's important to remember and acknowledge these inventions that paved the way for our modern-day utopia. The future holds limitless possibilities, and we can only imagine what groundbreaking inventions will emerge in the coming years, but we can be sure that they will build upon the foundations laid by these three inventions.

The three inventions 'inventing' our world - The globally interconnected Internet glides us smoothly into the future because of the Wheel and the Printing Press.

- Created using OpenAI's DALL-E.



SHE IS NOT JUST A WOMAN, SHE IS GOD!

Subhi Gupta | IB | Year, CIRS

Sindhu Tai, a mother to over 2100 orphaned children, took upon their responsibility when everyone else was unwilling to. Despite being thrown out of her own home by her own husband, she found the courage to give them the love and the home she never got for herself. The women of Bharat are misrepresented as delicate and fragile as a result of such stories going unheard. On the contrary, it is Bharat, whose very identity is built on its womanliness. Bharatiyas' very hearts swell with pride and devotion on hearing the words "Bharat Mata."

We, together, the country and people, are the grand celebration of the lives of women of this great nation. The grand celebration of women who have not just shaped the lives of remarkable men such as Bhagawan Shri Rama and Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj, but also of the women who have served as catalytic forces behind the transformation of, and the leaps taken in, the spiritual and cultural aspects of this country. From the times of the Rig Veda to the Modern Age, the knowledge and understanding of these women have most often been so empowering that the reading of their experiences alone has proved to be a life-changing and inspirational event for many seekers.

Anandibai Joshi, married at the tender age of 9, rose to become the first Indian female to study Western medicine in the United States during the British Raj, while becoming one of the earliest female physicians in the country. In the face of adversity, the young Anandibai remained steadfast and her spirit remained unbroken as she witnessed the death of her own newborn. However, amidst this, she uncovered the insatiable thirst for knowledge within her and set sail for distant shores to pursue her higher education, encouraging millions of other women to do the same.

Ahilyabai Holkar, following the death of her husband and father-in-law, became one of the finest female rulers in Indian history. By ruling the province of Malwa under the reign of justice and righteousness, she led the military front herself with arrows and bows, seated on an elephant. Regarded as one of the most visionary rulers of India and a brave warrior, it is said that during her rule, Malwa was never once attacked and remained an oasis of stability and peace.

Anandibai, Captain Lakshmi and Ahilyabai Holkar are just a few examples among millions of women who gracefully illustrated the balance of emotions and practicality, pleasure and spirituality, love and knowledge through the love of a mother, the valour of a warrior and the wisdom of a sage. At rather sensitive times, women were portrayed as inspirations and protectors of society rather than a burden, striving to make their great nation even greater. So, join us in celebrating and honouring the resilience and unwavering determination of these extraordinary women and the women in your own life - your grandmother, mother, sister, friend, or colleague. Dive deeper into their stories and let their journeys motivate you too.

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girl
up
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11

Oppenheimer

A Man Beyond Science



Sairam Gopal | Grade 8, CIRS

Bhagavad Gita, the beautiful song of the Mahabharat, has impacted the lives of innumerable people. The Bhagavad Gita delves into the core of human existence and encourages us to live a life of purity, strength, discipline, honesty, kindness and integrity. The Bhagavad Gita's influence lies not only within our land, but it has had its share of ardent devotees from outside the nation of Bharat as well, one of them being the well-renowned Father of the Atomic Bomb, J. Robert Oppenheimer.

Oppenheimer is remembered for his significant theoretical concepts and prowess regarding the atomic bomb. He coordinated and oversaw the Manhattan project which resulted in the release of the atomic bombs "Little Boy" and "Fat Man" on Hiroshima and Nagasaki. He was immensely fascinated by the philosophies of the Bhagavad Gita, particularly about the Vishvarupa Darshan which completely changed his perception of life.

But how did he get introduced to this text in inspite of him being a man of science?

During the 1930's, Oppenheimer was an Assistant Professor at UC Berkeley, but throughout this time, he taught and focused on Theoretical Physics. Alongside this, he did immense amounts of research collaborating with various other scientists. After what seemed to be an eternity of doing research, he decided to visit India for a short break in the 1930s. During this visit, he witnessed the beauty of Bharatiya tradition and culture. He was particularly captivated by the lessons and philosophies of the Gita. Oppenheimer believed that most of these philosophies perfectly aligned with his interpretations about quantum mechanics and the nature of this world. Hence, he decided to dive deeper into the greatest treatise of Bharatiya Itihaasa, the Bhagavad Gita. This connection became an integral part of his intellectual outlook, bringing about various changes in the way he lived life. He became so devoted that he even named his car 'Garuda'.

The teachings of doing one's duty plays an important role in our life. Much like how Sri Krishna had persuaded Arjuna to fulfil his duty to fight for Dharma. The Bhagavad Gita thus, enabled J. Robert Oppenheimer the Father of the Atom Bomb, to fulfil his duties and serve his country. This sense of devotion can also be seen when he quoted the Bhagavad Gita after the Trinity Test saying, "Now I am become Death, the destroyer of worlds."

श्रीभगवानुवाच

कालोऽस्मिलोकक्षयकृत्प्रवृद्धो लोकान्समाहर्तुमिहप्रवृत्तः ।
ऋतेऽपित्वांभविष्यन्तिसर्वे येऽवस्थिताः प्रत्यनीकेषु योधाः ॥३२॥

For Oppenheimer, the Gita was not just a religious text, it was a source of liberation which offered him the principles and wisdom necessary for navigating through the difficulties of the material world while opening the doors to the spiritual world. The knowledge transformed him and ignited the flame for dedicating his life to peace. After the Manhattan Project was complete, he spent the rest of his life being the Director of the Institute of Advanced Study at Princeton. He had given up his public life, but even in the end, he never gave up the knowledge the Gita imparted within him.







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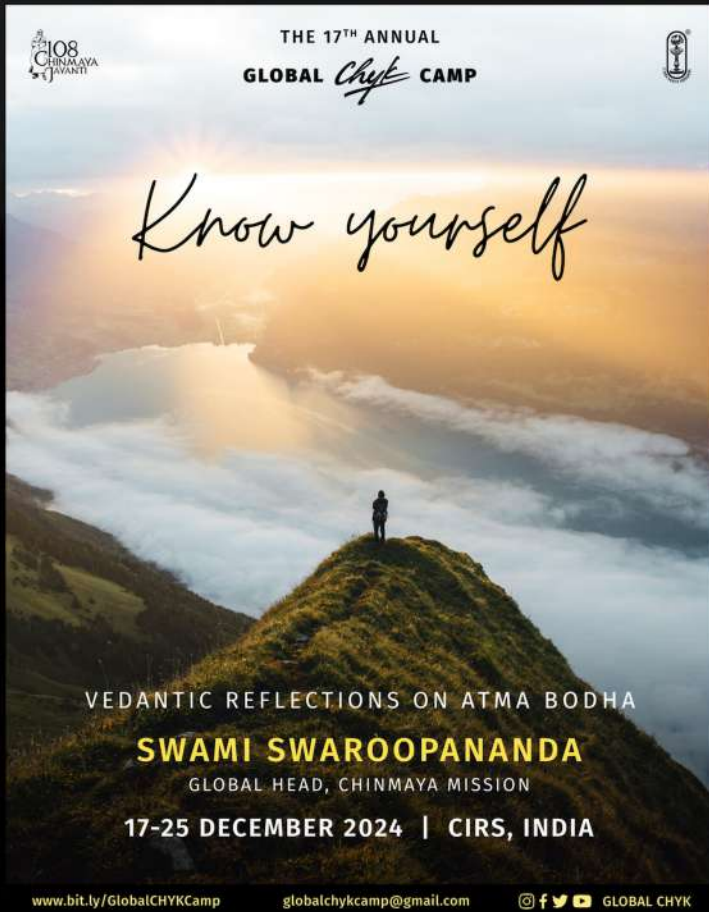


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Swami Chinmayananda

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